

In support of the EU Sustainable Cocoa Initiative



**THE EU
SUSTAINABLE
COCOA PROGRAMME**

In Cameroon



**Sustainable Agriculture
for Forest Ecosystems**

Published by

giz Deutsche Gesellschaft
für internationale
Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH



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Ministry of Foreign Affairs



**Everything you need to know
about the new European Union
regulation on deforestation and
the cocoa industry in Cameroon**



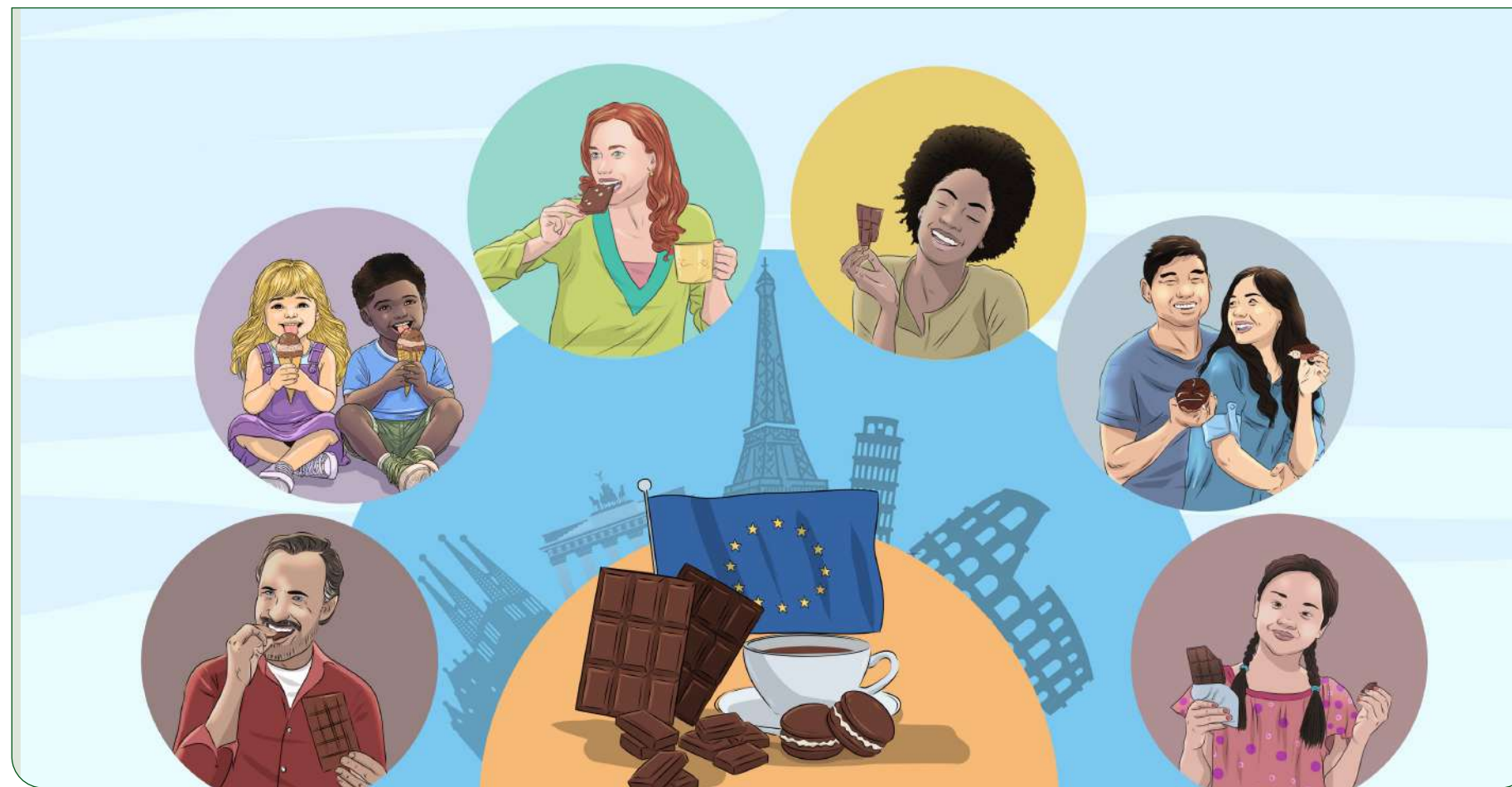
1 The world's main cocoa producers



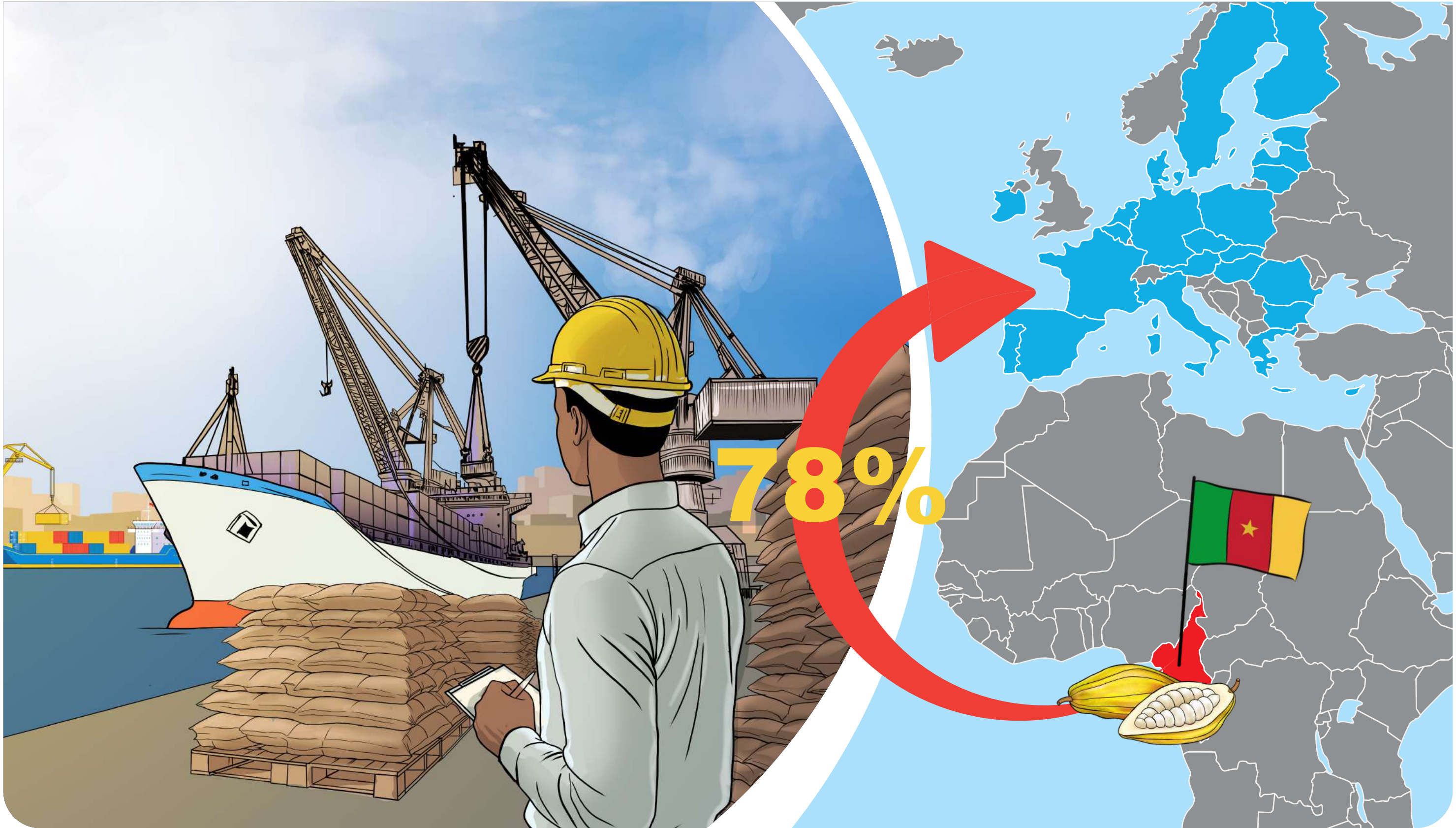
Cameroon is the 4th largest producer in the world, and the 3rd largest in Africa (after Côte d'Ivoire and Ghana).



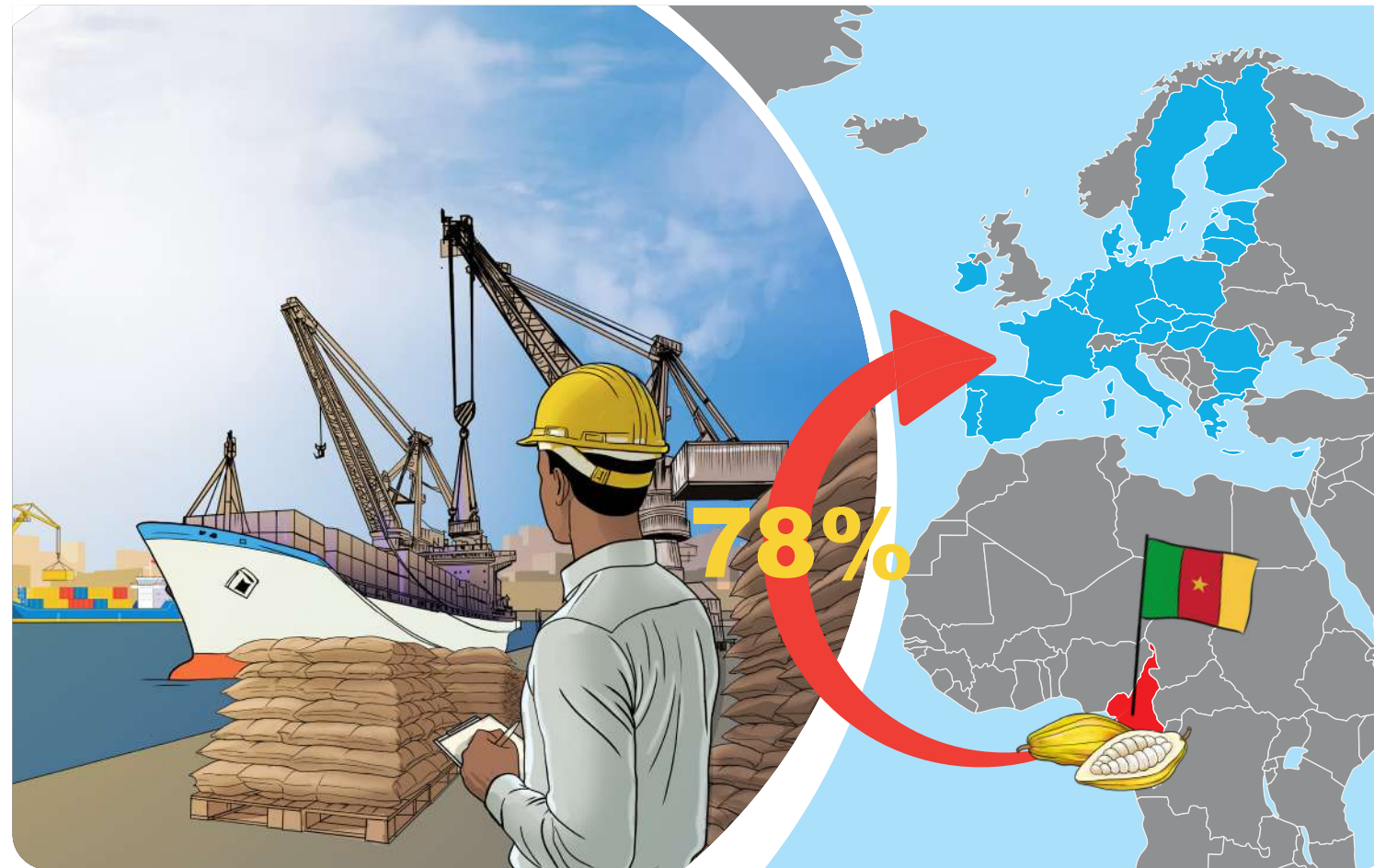
2 Europe is the largest consumer of chocolate



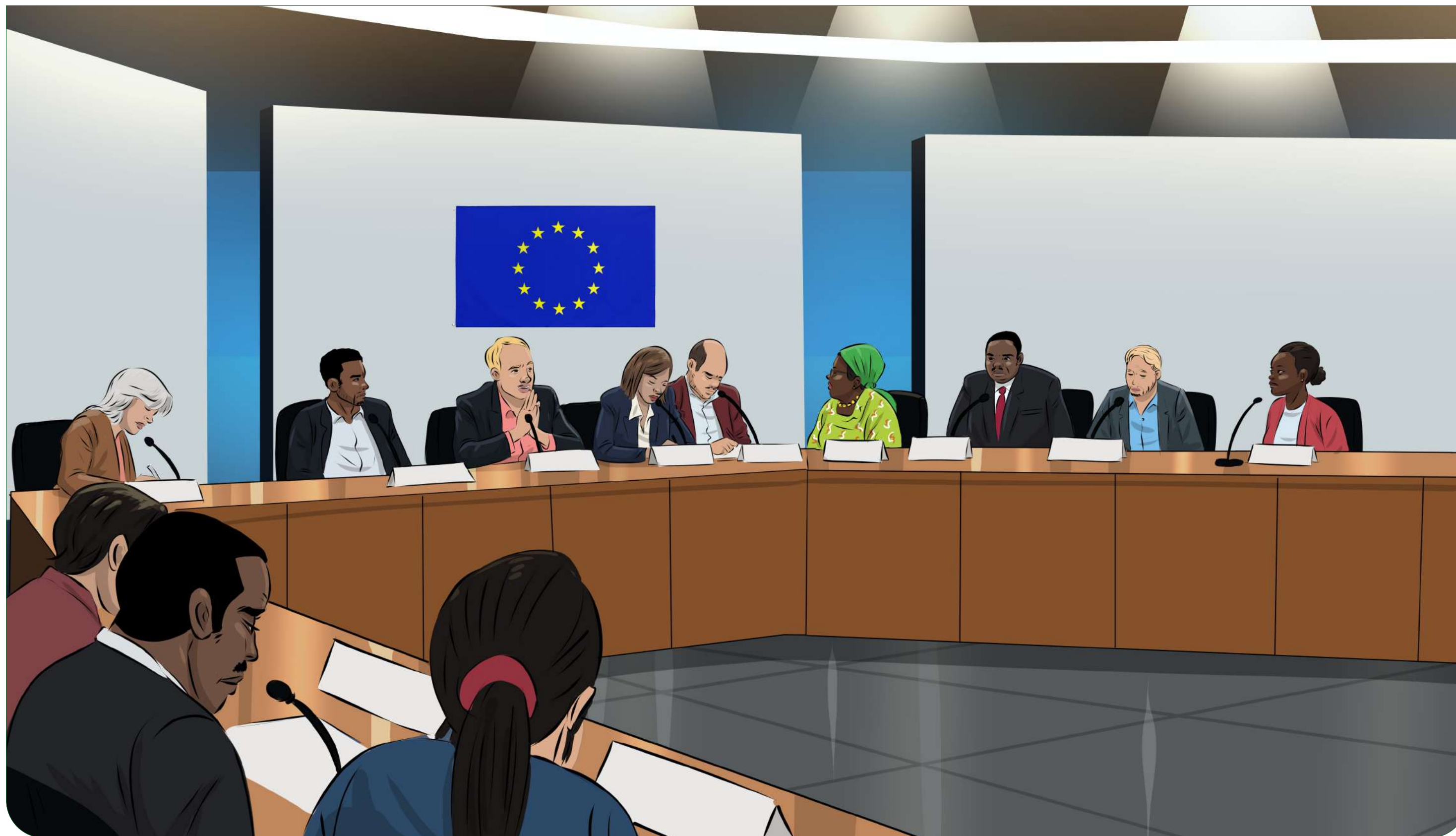
Europe consumes the most chocolate.



3 Percentage of cocoa exports to the EU



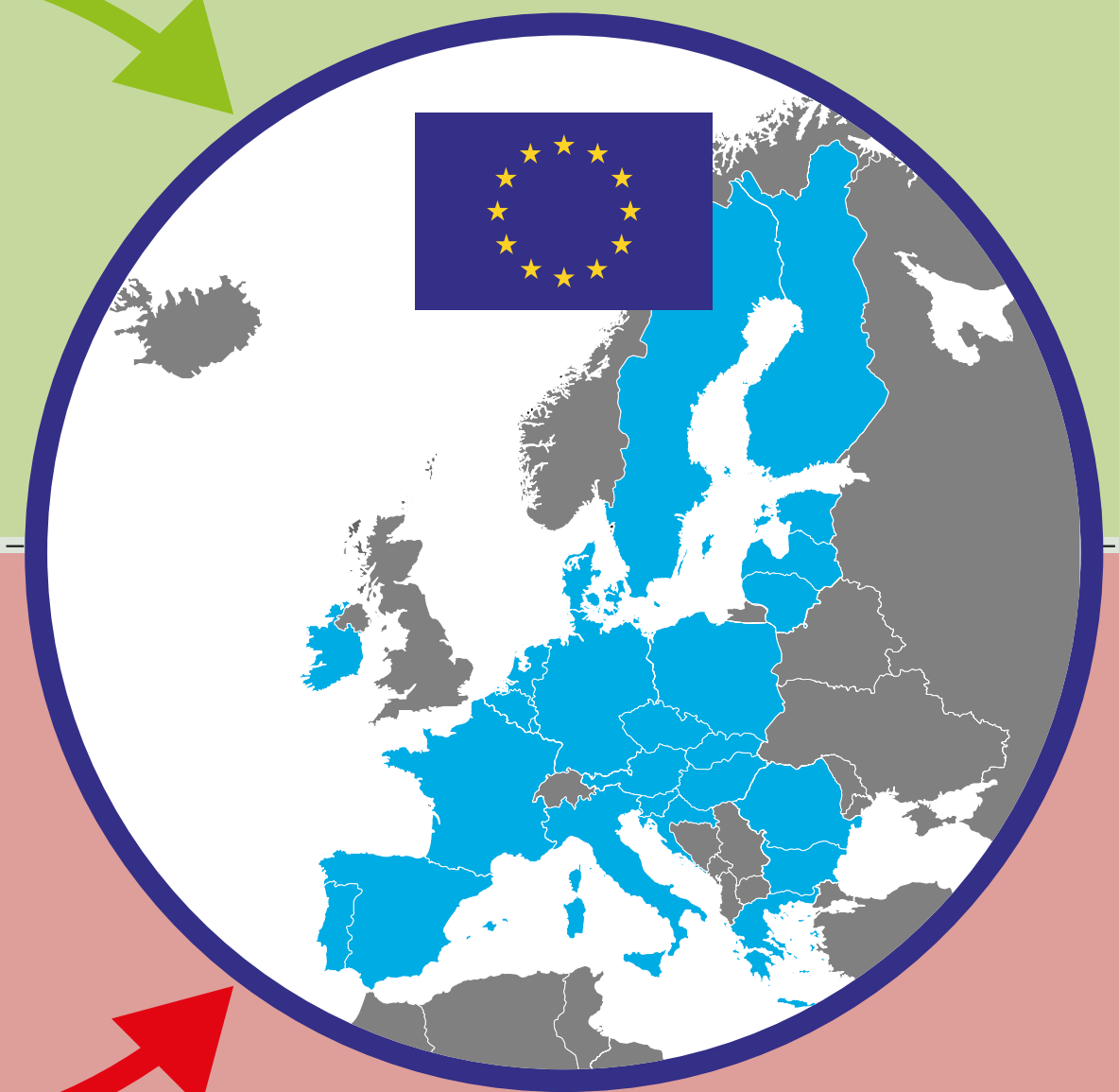
Europeans are the main buyers of Cameroonian cocoa (78% in 2022-23).



4 Public demand to end deforestation



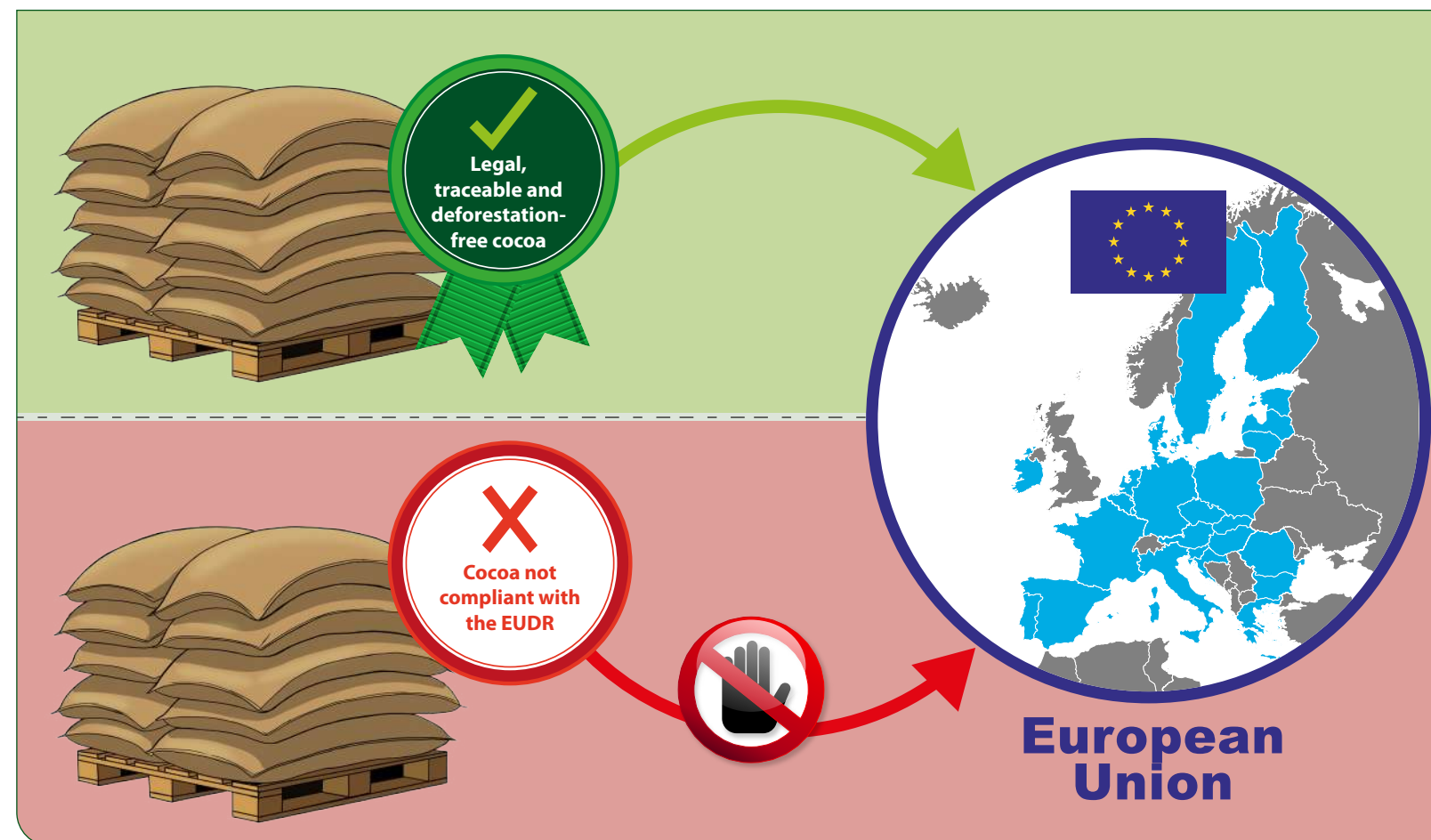
Many members of the public took part in a citizens' consultation and pushed the EU to adopt a new regulation: the European Union Deforestation Regulation (EUDR).



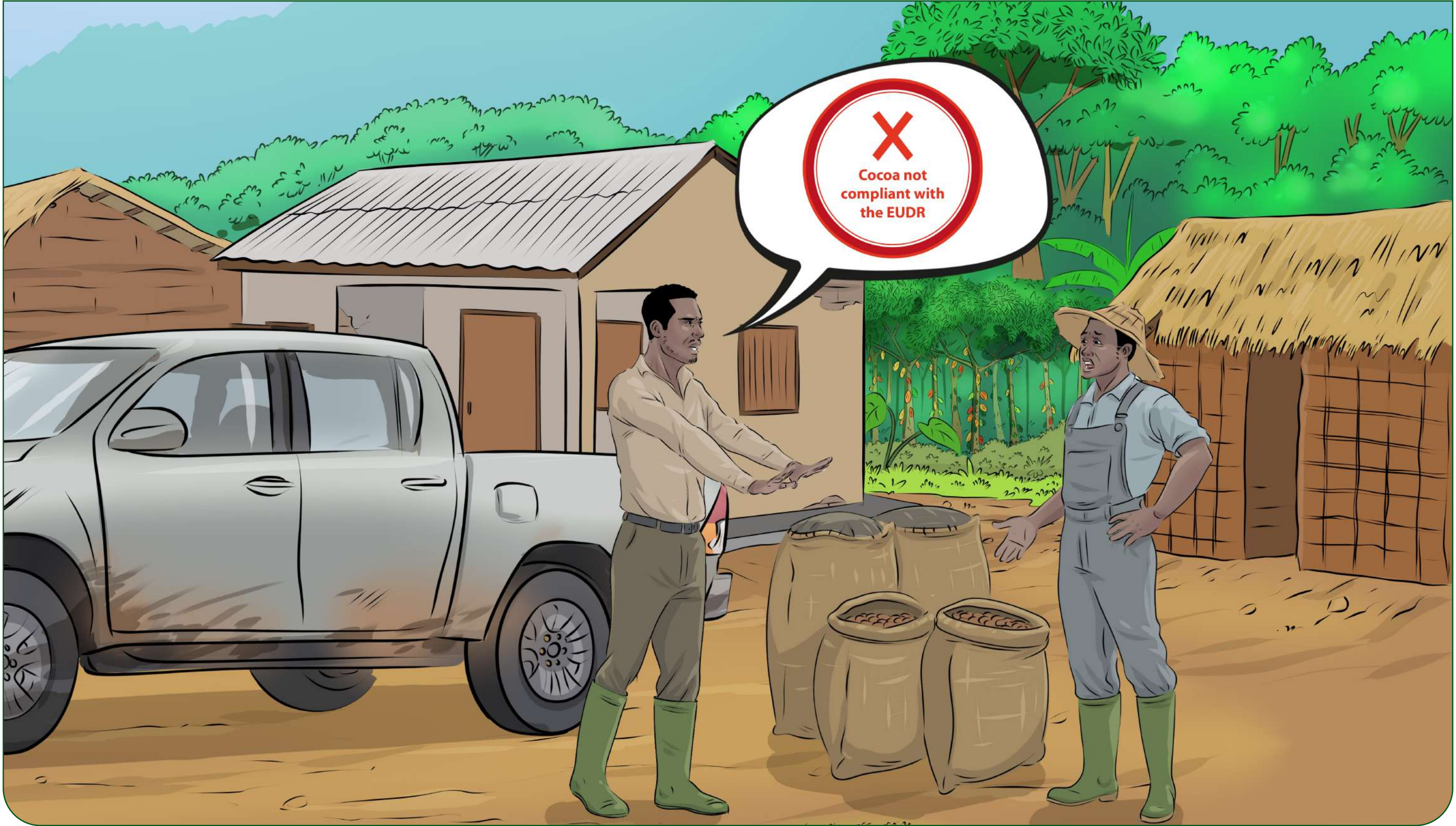
**European
Union**



5 Which cocoa will be accepted in the EU market?

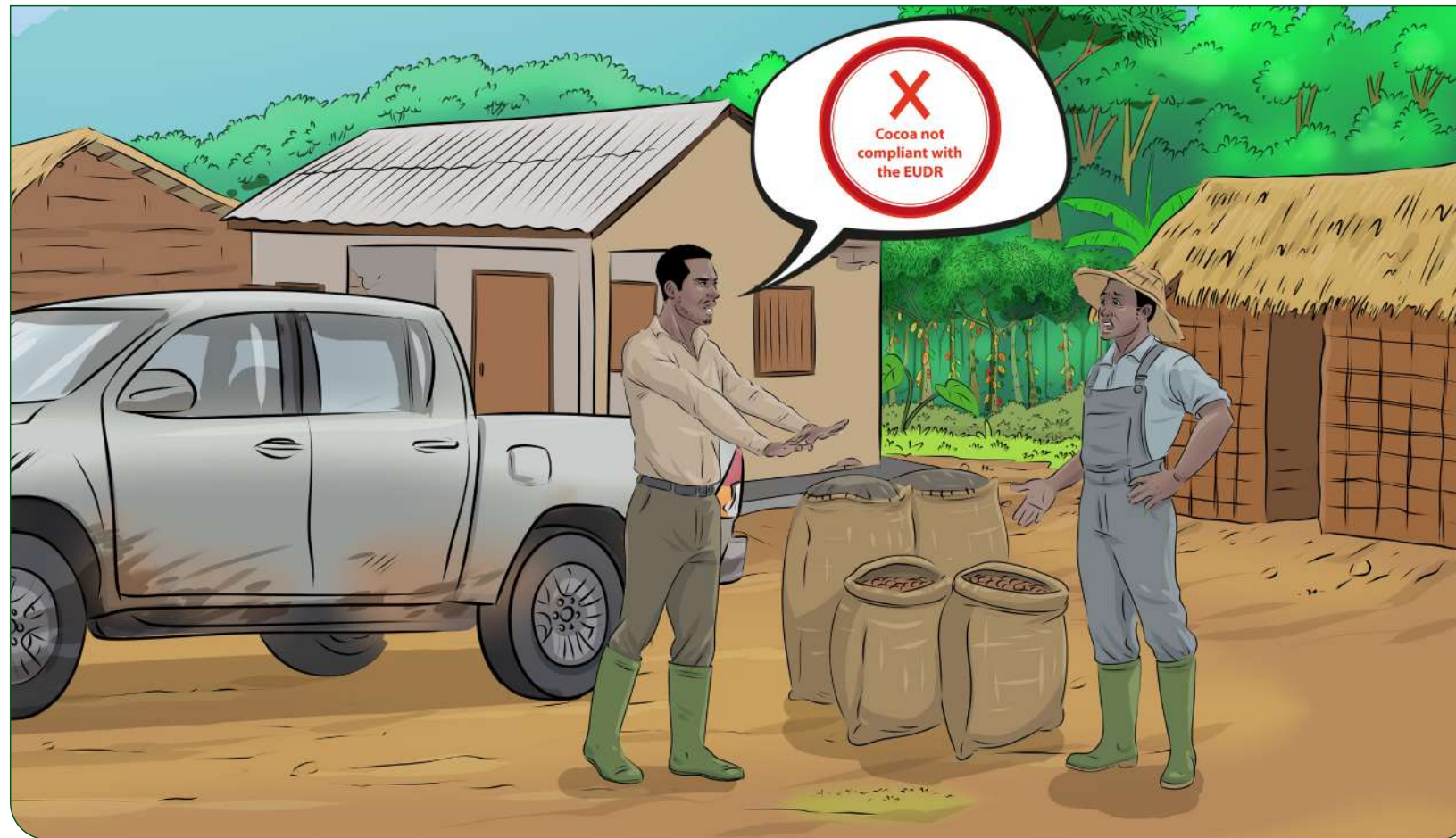


This regulation stipulates that cocoa placed on the European Union market must be deforestation-free, traceable and legally produced.



X
Cocoa not
compliant with
the EUDR

6 Cocoa that does not comply with the EUDR



This regulation specifies that cocoa produced through deforestation occurring after 2020 can no longer be sold in the European Union.



Surface area?
Height?
Forest cover?

7 What is considered a forest under the EUDR?



Under both the EUDR and Cameroonian regulation, a 'forest' is defined as a minimum of 0.5 hectare, a minimum of 10% forest cover and a minimum tree height of 5 metres.



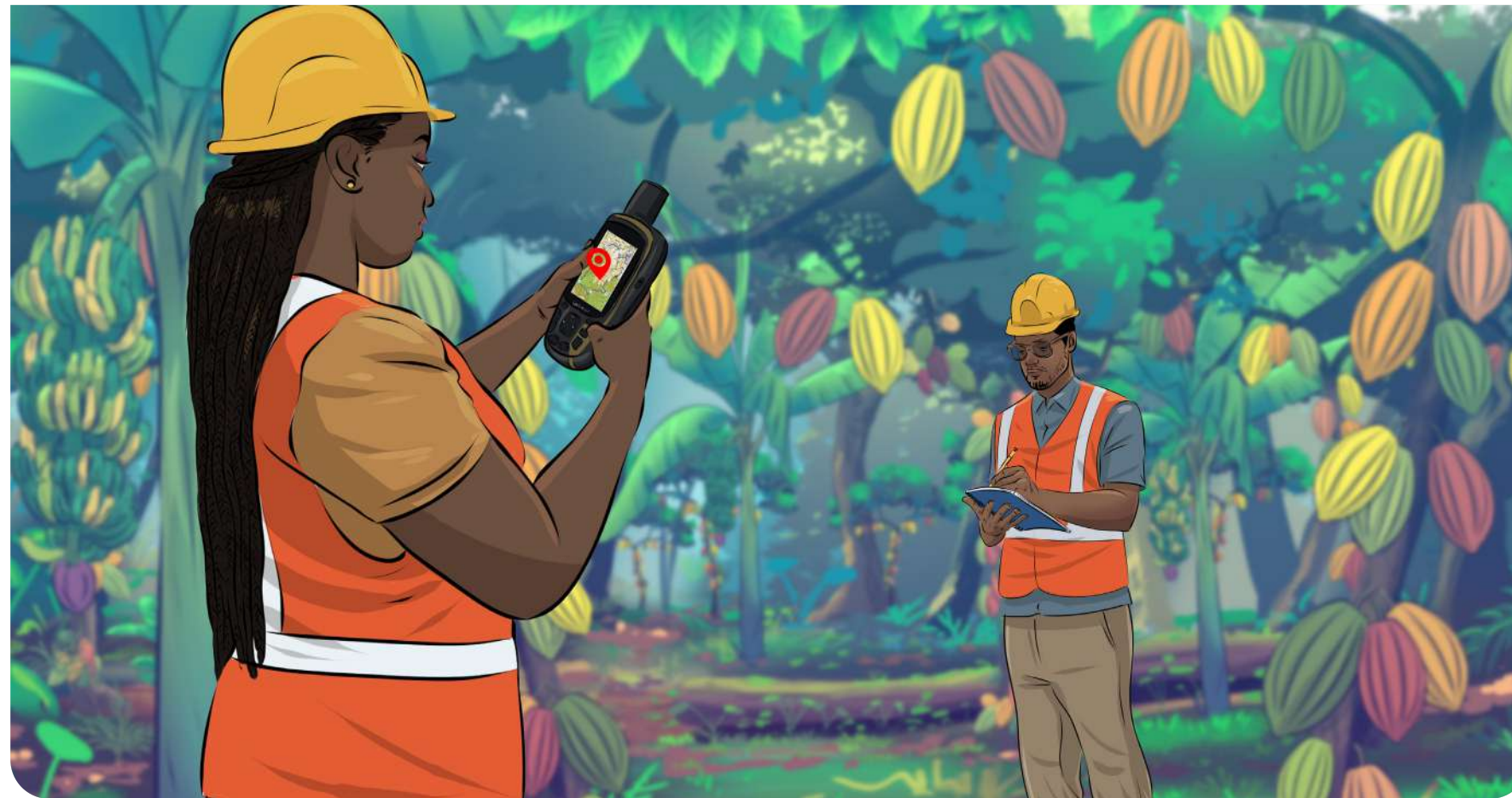
8 Agroforests are not considered forests



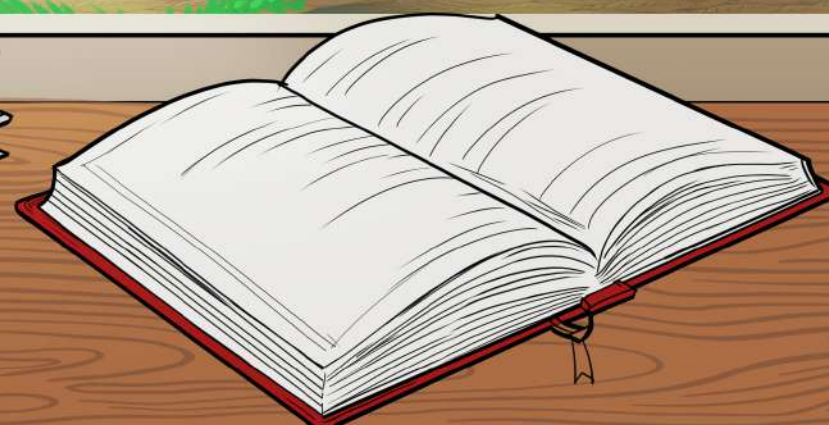
It is important to note that for the EUDR, cocoa agroforests are not considered as forests.



9 Geolocation of cocoa plots



This regulation requires cocoa farms to be geolocated.



10 Cocoa must comply with the law



This regulation requires cocoa to be produced in accordance with the laws of Cameroon.



11 Where is cocoa planting forbidden under Cameroonian law?



Under Cameroonian law, cocoa is not legal if it is produced in Forest Management Units (FMUs), communal forests and protected areas (national parks, forest reserves, etc.).



12 Where is cocoa planting permitted?



Cocoa planted in community forests, national forests and private forests is legal if allowed in the forest management document, and only in the planned zone(s).



13 Important information: the EUDR excludes all cocoa planted in forests



That said, even if it is legal in Cameroon, any cocoa from areas deforested after 2020, whether in the permanent or non-permanent forest estate, cannot be sold in the EU.



14 Respecting land tenure and use rights



Under Cameroonian laws, cocoa must be produced on land that belongs to the producer or over which he has usage rights.



15 Respecting children's rights



Under Cameroonian law, children working on cocoa farms must be able to continue going to school and must not perform dangerous tasks.



16 How can we adapt to these new requirements?



So, what can we do if we want to continue selling our cocoa in the European Union?



17 No new cocoa plantations in forest areas



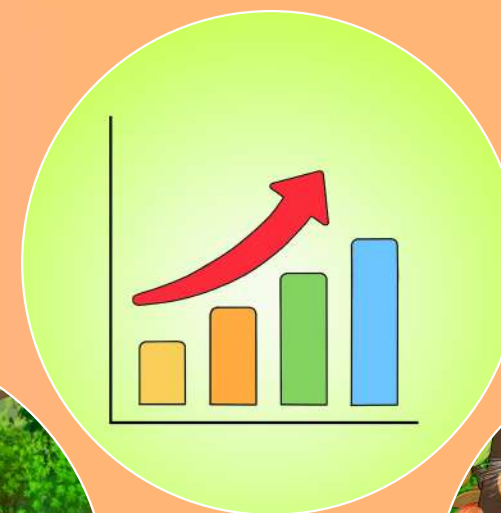
Do not create new plantations in the forest (even in community forests and national forests).



18 Planting on fallow and previously cultivated land



Create new cocoa plantations in already cultivated areas or fallow land.



19 The importance of reinvesting to increase crops



With the money currently being made from cocoa, it is advisable to invest in increasing yields and the resilience of plantations, through the implementation of good practices: shade management, re-densification, pruning, fertilisation, treatments against disease and improved fermentation.



20 Sustainable cocoa that respects the environment



In the end, we hope that producers will receive a fair income while preserving forests and biodiversity.

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